



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Saint John Bosco Academy
School Website: <https://www.sjbacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School

School website used for this audit: <https://bishopreicher.com/>

Executive Summary - Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Why: The school explicitly frames education around truth, goodness, and beauty, virtue formation, and a Catholic liberal arts identity with integrated theology and robust liturgical life—strong classical signals. It also includes Latin and classic literature (Great Books authors). However, the site gives limited evidence of classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, chanting/recitation, rhetoric orations), and features prominent modern □ school markers (21st □ century technology, robotics, AP/PSAT emphasis, "Social Studies") that dilute the classical profile. On balance, the philosophical/theological foundations are classical; pedagogy and some curriculum signaling are weak to mixed.

- Method: Keyword analysis aligned to the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon (positive/negative indicators) was performed across the school's public site copy and compared against the reference lists.

How to read this report - For each category, we list: (1) keywords found on the school site, (2) alignment to the Six Elements positive/negative keyword lists, (3) quantitative hit estimates, and (4) a category rating.

Sources for the keyword framework - Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (positive/negative keyword indicators across all six categories)

- Classicality lexicon (compact keyword list by category)

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations 1) Keywords found (from school site) - Transcendentals/virtue: "good, true, and beautiful"; "virtue"; "wisdom"

- Theology integrated: "Catholic liberal arts curriculum that cultivates wisdom [and] virtue"; "four □ year theology program," "sacred scripture," "moral and sacramental life," "nature of the Church"

- Liturgical life: "daily prayer," "weekly Mass," "Eucharist," "sacred liturgy and music"

- Virtue program: "Education in Virtue," "faith, hope, and charity," "prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance" (Aquinas)

2) Alignment to Six Elements keywords

- Strong matches to positive indicators: truth/goodness/beauty; virtue; theology; sacred scripture; Mass/Eucharist; liturgy; prayer; catechesis; formation.
- No notable negative indicators (e.g., "values-neutral," "religiously neutral").

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 14; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100%
- Coverage of category cues (transcendentals; theology integration; liturgy/communal worship): high → percent_coverage ≈ 95%
- pos_neg_hits: +14/□0

4) Rating: CLASSICAL Justification: Direct and repeated references to theology, liturgy, and transcendental moral realism fit the classical model's foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal 1) Keywords found - Formation aim: “cultivates wisdom [and] virtue,” “forms saints, scholars, and leaders,” “virtuous disciples of Christ”
- Transcendentals: “what is good, true, and beautiful” - Mixed aims (modern focus): “college prep,” “PSAT,” “AP Calculus,” “21st century...technology,” “STEM [Robotics], hands-on learning”

2) Alignment

- Positive: wisdom, virtue, truth/goodness/beauty, formation language—strong classical aims.
- Negative: college-prep/AP/PSAT/21st-century skills/STEM marketing—signals pragmatism/skills orientation that can pull against classical ends.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 8; Negative hits: 5 → percent_positive ≈ 61%
- Coverage: purpose statements include both transcendental/virtue and practical aims → percent_coverage ≈ 80%
- pos_neg_hits: +8/□5

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Mission language is classically aligned, but mixed with strong “college/career” and skills-forward messaging.

Element 3: School Curriculum 1) Keywords found - Liberal arts/classics: “Catholic liberal arts”; “modern and classical languages”; “Latin”; “classic literature...Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare, Dickens, Austen, Fitzgerald” (Great Books signals); four-year theology program.

- History vs. social studies: Elementary list includes “Social Studies” (negative signal vs. “History”). - Quadrivium/Trivium terms explicit? Not observed on site (no “grammar/logic/rhetoric” terms in public copy checked).

2) Alignment

- Positive: liberal arts identity; Latin/classical languages; canonical authors/primary texts; theology integrated.
- Negative: “Social Studies” label; STEM/AP emphasis overshadowing classical structure.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 6; Negative hits: 4 → percent_positive ≈ 60%
- Coverage of core cues (Trivium/Quadrivium terms, Great Books/primary sources, history-not-social-studies, wonder): mixed—Great Books/Latin present; explicit Trivium/Quadrivium absent; “Social Studies” present; “wonder” not explicit → percent_coverage ≈ 60%
- pos_neg_hits: +6/□4

4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Content shows classical elements (Latin, classic authors, theology), but lacks explicit Trivium/Quadrivium signaling and includes “Social Studies” and strong AP/STEM marketing.

Element 4: School Pedagogy (Teaching Methods) 1) Keywords found - Classical pedagogy (expected): Socratic, dialectic/seminar, scholé/restful learning, chanting/recitation, rhetoric orations—no direct mentions found in audited pages. - Negative pedagogy signals: “hands-on learning,” “projects/competitions,” “21st-century technology,” “problem-solving, coding, engineering,” “Google Classroom” adoption pitched as efficiency; “AP”/“PSAT” performance framing.

2) Alignment

- Positive: Choir/Fine Arts are present but do not, by themselves, evidence classical recitation/chant or mimetic practice. No explicit Socratic/seminar/scholé language located.
- Negative: numerous terms aligning with experiential/project/skills-first framing.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 0–1 (weak, general arts references only); Negative hits: 6 → percent_positive ≈ 15%
- Coverage: little to no explicit evidence of classical methods → percent_coverage ≈ 30%
- pos_neg_hits: +1/□6

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- 4) Rating: NOT CLASSICAL Justification: Public copy doesn't surface Socratic/seminar, scholé/rest, memorization/recitation, or explicit rhetoric training; instead, it highlights modern tech/STEM/efficiency framing.

Element 5: Faculty 1) Keywords found - Site emphasizes "dedicated faculty" and formation context; explicit teacher as mentor/model language is scarce in public copy. Visit/admissions copy invites families to meet "dedicated faculty" and form a "partnership."

- Staff pages list leadership; campus minister present (formation context).

2) Alignment

- Positive indicators desired: "teachers as models of virtue," "mentorship," "portrait of a teacher," "faculty of friends," "classical teacher formation." Mixed/inconclusive; some formation context, but little explicit teacher formation language.

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100% (but low volume)
- Coverage: limited explicit signaling → percent_coverage ≈ 30%
- pos_neg_hits: +2/0

- 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Hints of formation with faith context, but missing explicit classical teacher formation claims.

Element 6: Parents and Community 1) Keywords found - Partnership: "we partner with families" (Virtues Program); "Family Meeting...first step in forming a partnership with you"; multiple open access events (Open House, Tours, "Cougar Coffee, Talk & Tour," Shadow Day).

- Parent formation/book studies: not observed in audited pages.

2) Alignment

- Positive: "parent partnership" aligns to classical community ethos.
- Gaps: little evidence of parent formation offerings (e.g., book groups on classical ed).

3) Quantitative estimate

- Positive hits: 4; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive ≈ 100%
- Coverage: partnership and open campus present; parent formation materials not seen → percent_coverage ≈ 60%
- pos_neg_hits: +4/0

- 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Clear partnership and access; add parent formation for stronger alignment.

Aggregate classification - Category ratings: [1] Classical; [2] Somewhat Classical; [3] Somewhat Classical; [4] Not Classical; [5] Somewhat Classical; [6] Somewhat Classical - Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Publish classical pedagogy evidence: - Name and describe Socratic seminars, dialectic practices, and rhetoric (speeches/orations, debates) in Middle/Upper School syllabi and pages; show exemplars/theses. - Surface memorization/recitation (poetry, catechism, hymns) and lower school chanting practices. - Articulate "scholé/restful learning" and "wonder" as pedagogical commitments (festina lente; multum non multa). - Strengthen curriculum signaling: - Explicitly use Trivium/Quadrivium language; map courses to grammar/logic/rhetoric; spotlight Quadrivium elements where present. - Replace "Social Studies" with "History" on elementary pages; highlight primary sources across grades. - Clarify telos over pragmatics: - Reframe AP/PSAT/"21st century skills" within a subordinate role to wisdom/virtue and the pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty (keep data, change emphasis/tones). - Faculty formation: - Publish a "Portrait of a Teacher" and evidence of ongoing classical pedagogy formation (e.g., Great Books seminars for faculty, classical workshops). - Parent formation: - Offer and advertise parent reading groups or classical education seminars; share reading lists (Great Books, liberal arts).

Citations to school evidence (selected) - “good, true, and beautiful”; “forms saints, scholars, leaders” (Visit)
- “Catholic liberal arts...cultivates wisdom, virtue” (Admissions) - “Latin,” “daily prayer,” “weekly Mass,” “Eucharist” (5–8 Overview) - “four□year theology...sacred scripture...sacramental life” (High School Program)
- “Education in Virtue...faith, hope, charity; prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance” (Virtues) - “Social Studies” (Elementary overview) - Robotics/technology (hands□on, 21st□century tech; Google Classroom)

Six Elements keyword framework (for comparison) - Positive indicators for all six categories, including truth/-goodness/beauty, theology/liturgy, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary texts, Socratic/scholé/recitation, teacher as model/mentor, and parent partnership; with negative indicators such as values□neutrality, STEM□first framing, project□based dominance, and 21st□century skills as primary aims.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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